# ACC250: Introduction to Financial Accounting

## 2026 Fall

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|---|---|
| **Best Way to Reach Me:** | Email |
| **Office Hours:** | Grawn 328 \| MW 11:45 – 12:30 |
| | Virtual (Link) \| F 09:00–10:30 (e-mail me if it doesn't work.) |
| **Lecture Room & Hours:** | Grawn 301\| MW 12:30 – 13:45 (22478925) |
| | MW 14:00 – 15:15 (22478923) |
| | MW 15:30 – 16:45 (22478922) |
| **Lecture Period:** | 8/31/26 – 12/12/26 (Exam week: 12/14 – 12/18) |
| **Course Format:** | In-person classroom |
| **Absence/Tardiness:** | **Google form [click here]** \| submit **in advance** |
| **Late Submission:** | **Google form [click here]** \| submit **before the deadline** |
| **Missing an Exam:** | **Google form [click here]** \| submit **as soon as possible** |

## Contents

**1 Communication** **2**

**2 Expectations** **2**

**3 Course Rules/Etiquettes** **2**

**4 Course Description & Learning Objectives** **2**

**5 Course Materials** **3**

**6 Grading** **3**
- 6.1 Attendance & Participation . . . 3
- 6.2 Homework Assignments . . . 4
- 6.3 Exams . . . 4

**7 Course Schedule (Tentative)** **5**

**8 Other Information** **6**
- 8.1 Extra Credits . . . 6
- 8.2 Presentation . . . 6
- 8.3 Inclusive Access Program . . . 6
- 8.4 Financial Statement Data Sources . . . 6
- 8.5 Academic Integrity Policy . . . 6
- 8.6 Disability Accommodation . . . 6

# 1 Communication

- The best way to reach me is via **email**, especially if you have an urgent issue.
- Include **course code**, **starting time** of your section, and the **key matter** in the **email subject** line.
  - Example of a good subject line: **"ACC250 | 14:00 | Questions about Revenue Recognition"**
- Use **professional language** in all communications.
- Allow **48 hours** for email responses during business days.
- Keep in mind normal working hours (09:00 – 17:00, Monday through Friday).
- Use the **Google form [click here]** for **attendance matters** (incl. absence, tardiness, and leaving early).
- Use the **Google form [click here]** for **late submission**.
- Use the **Google form [click here]** if you **cannot take an exam**.

# 2 Expectations

You are expected to:

- attend all classes and participate in class discussions.
- read each chapter of the textbook before we begin it in class.
- complete all assignments.
- take all exams.

I may **cold-call** you during class, so come prepared.

# 3 Course Rules/Etiquettes

Please adhere to the following as a courtesy to both your fellow students and the instructor:

1. **Integrity.** Work you submit must be the product of your own efforts. This includes **dishonesty involving the use of AI**. Cheating results in a grade of **F** for the course.
2. **Presence.** **Remain in attendance** for the duration of class, except in an emergency. Inform your instructor **ahead of time** if you must **leave early**.
3. **Focus.** Treat this course as a professional engagement: **no private conversations or messaging** during class.
4. **Devices.** Use technology only for **course-related** activity. Your **screen is visible to your neighbors**, and off-task use — social media, streaming, or homework for this and other classes — decreases **both your learning and theirs**.

**Violations of course etiquette** will have substantial consequences (e.g., participation score, grade adjustments), and the instructor decides on their severity.

**Use of IT devices in Class**

- **You are not allowed** to use your laptop, smartphone, or other IT devices during class hours. **Handouts are provided**, so you do not need them for note-taking. Engaging in **any non-course-related activity** — including **homework for this course** — is not allowed.
- Use your IT devices **only when**:
  - I **instruct you** to do so for an in-class activity (e.g., **Google Forms**, **Socrative**); or
  - you have my **permission in advance** for a course-related purpose.
- You are expected to **bring your own laptop**, but only for the cases above.
- **Violation of this policy may result in a failing grade (F) for the course.**

The full **Academic Integrity Policy** is in Section 8.5.

# 4 Course Description & Learning Objectives

This course mainly covers **1) balance sheet and 2) income statement**, the two of four financial statements public companies need to prepare periodically. Two other financial statements — **3) statement of shareholders' equity and 4) cash flow statements** — are covered briefly.

| Ch | Title |
|---|---|
| **Part 1 (Ch1–4):** Financial Statements Overview | |
| 1 | Business decisions and financial accounting |
| 2 | The Balance Sheet |
| 3 | The Income Statement |
| 4 | Adjustments and financial statements |
| **Part 2 (Ch6–8):** Operating Activities | |
| 6 | Merchandising operations |
| 7 | Inventory and cost of goods sold |
| 8 | Receivables and bad debt expense |
| **Part 3 (Ch9–11):** Investing & Financing Activities | |
| 9 | Long-lived tangible assets |
| 10 | Liabilities |
| 11 | Stockholders' equity |

At the end of the course, students are expected to:

1. Understand basic financial accounting principles
   - Revenue recognition
   - Matching principle (for expense)
   - Cost principle (for assets)
2. Understand the elements of the four financial statements.
3. Describe the relationship between four financial statements.
4. Analyze **financial statements of public firms** (see Section 8.4).
5. Conduct basic financial ratio analysis.

# 5 Course Materials

1. **Lecture slides**
2. **Fundamentals of Financial Accounting** by Phillips et al., 8th Edition[1]
3. All course content is housed in our course shell on Blackboard.

# 6 Grading

| Component | Percentage |
|---|---|
| Attendance & Participation | 15% |
| Homework Assignments | 25% |
| Exam 1 | 15% |
| Exam 2 | 20% |
| Exam 3 (Final) | 25% |
| **Total** | **100%** |

| F | D- | D | D+ | C- | C | C+ | B- | B | B+ | A- | A |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 00–60 | 60–64 | 64–67 | 67–70 | 70–74 | 74–77 | 77–80 | 80–84 | 84–87 | 87–90 | 90–94 | 94–100 |

## 6.1 Attendance & Participation

- **Attendance is mandatory**. It is checked through two things: whether you **actually came to the session**, and your **participation in Socrative-based activities**. If you do not participate, you are **marked absent** for that session.[2]
- Attendance is checked randomly, 10+ times in total.
  - A **designated seat** will be assigned for attendance checks.
  - The seat you choose in the **first session after Week 1** will be your designated seat for the semester.

[1] This course uses the **Inclusive Access** program — see Section 8.3.

[2] Missing a single activity does not make you absent — if a session has three activities and you miss one, that is not an absence. As long as you are actually there and participate at a reasonable level, you are fine.

  - Seats at the back of the classroom will be blocked.
- You will receive **full credit** if you (1) **attend all sessions**; (2) **participate in in-class activities** (e.g., Socrative-based interactions); and (3) **follow this course guideline**, especially the **course etiquettes** (Section 3) and **academic integrity** (Section 8.5).
- **Extra participation** beyond the above will be considered as **extra credit**.

**Absence & Tardiness**

- If you want an absence or tardiness **excused**, complete this **Google form [click here] in advance**, then provide **written documentation** (e.g., doctor's note). You **do not have to email me** separately, as I monitor the form responses.
- All absences without written documentation will be considered **unexcused**.

**Accommodation for Absences**

To accommodate unexpected situations, **up to two undocumented absences** may be treated as excused if you follow the **course guidelines and etiquettes** and **actively participate** throughout the semester. If you do not need an excuse, there is **no need to submit the form** — the absence simply counts as one of these two.

## 6.2 Homework Assignments

- All assignments are **equally important** and will be averaged.
- Due dates are always on **Sunday**.
- Four types of assignments:
  1. Reading: You are expected to read the **entire chapter** before we begin it in class. This is **not graded** on its own.
  2. SmartBook: Your reading is checked through the **SmartBook** assignment via **CONNECT**.
  3. Practice Problems: Problem-solving assignments for each chapter.
  4. Others: The **Resume Workshop** and the **Accounting Cycle Project**, to be announced on **Blackboard**.

**Submitting Your Assignments**

You must click **"Submit"** to turn in an assignment. Work left unsubmitted — even if you answered every question — **will not be graded**, and **no exception will be made**. Always confirm that your submission is recorded before the deadline. I deliberately do **not** turn on **automatic submission**, because doing so would close off the **late submission** option below.

**Late Submission for Assignments**

- If you have a valid reason with a written evidence (doctor's note, etc.), your late submission can be executed. To do so, you need to submit a **late submission form** before the deadline.
- Otherwise, late assignments will be accepted with a **one-time 20% penalty**, and only **up to one week** after the deadline. You do **not need to get my permission** for this.

**Accommodation for Assignments**

To accommodate unexpected absences or circumstances, your **two lowest assignment scores will be dropped** if you follow the **course guidelines and etiquettes** and **actively participate** throughout the semester.

## 6.3 Exams

- Three exams take place in the classroom during class time.
- A calculator is allowed. **Notes are not allowed.**

| Exam | Chapters covered |
|---|---|
| Exam 1 | 1, 2, 3 |
| Exam 2 | 4, 6, 7 + 3 |
| Exam 3 | 8, 9, 10, 11 + 4 |

**Missing an Exam**

If you cannot take an exam for a legitimate reason, submit the **Google form [click here] as soon as possible** — and **definitely no later than three days before the exam**, unless a genuine emergency makes that impossible. Attach **supporting documentation** (e.g., doctor's note). You **do not have to email me** separately, as I monitor the form responses. If you **miss any exam without such advance notice**, you are **not able to pass this course**.

# 7 Course Schedule (Tentative)

| Week | Monday | | Wednesday | | Others |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 08/31 | 1-1. Introduction | 09/02 | 1-2. Ch0 | |
| 2 | 09/07 | No Class (Labor Day) | 09/09 | 1-3. Ch1 | |
| 3 | 09/14 | 1-4. Ch1, Ch2 | 09/16 | 1-5. Ch2 | **Resume Workshop (09/15)** |
| 4 | 09/21 | 1-6. Ch3 | 09/23 | 1-7. Ch3 | |
| 5 | 09/28 | 1-8. Ch3 | 09/30 | 1-9. **Review** | |
| 6 | 10/05 | **Exam** | 10/07 | 2-1. Ch4 | |
| 7 | 10/12 | No Class (Fall Break) | 10/14 | 2-2. Ch4 | |
| 8 | 10/19 | 2-3. Ch4 | 10/21 | 2-4. Ch6 | |
| 9 | 10/26 | 2-5. Ch6 | 10/28 | 2-6. Ch7 | |
| 10 | 11/02 | 2-7. Ch7 | 11/04 | 2-8. **Review** | |
| 11 | 11/09 | **Exam** | 11/11 | 3-1. Ch8 | |
| 12 | 11/16 | 3-2. Ch8 | 11/18 | 3-3. Ch9 | |
| 13 | 11/23 | 3-4. Ch9 | 11/25 | 3-5. Ch9, Ch10 | |
| 14 | 11/30 | 3-6. Ch10 | 12/02 | 3-7. Ch10 | |
| 15 | 12/07 | 3-8. Ch11 | 12/09 | 3-9. Ch11 & **Review** | |
| **Exam week: 12/14 – 12/18 (final exam — see below)** | | | | | |

| **Final Exam** | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Your Section** | **Date** | **Starts at** |
| MW 12:30 – 13:45 | Monday, 12/14 | 12:00 |
| MW 14:00 – 15:15 | Monday, 12/14 | 14:00 |
| MW 15:30 – 16:45 | Wednesday, 12/16 | 14:00 |

Click here for the final exam schedule.

# 8 Other Information

## 8.1 Extra Credits

- Given only to those who **attend the session** and **follow the course guidelines**; **no make-up**.
- I take extra credit into account when **determining your final grade** at the end of the semester. This adjustment is **entirely at my discretion**.
- Good examples of what earns extra credit:
  1. **Active in-class participation**.
  2. **Spotting errors in the lecture notes** (so pay attention!).
  3. **Helping your peers understand** the material in class.
  4. **Pop-up quizzes** (if any).

## 8.2 Presentation

This is a great opportunity to go deeper into a case that is relevant to accounting and to business in general. If you are **genuinely interested** in any of the topics below, please let me know. Each case includes a **link as a starting point** — dig into the material yourself from there. Presentations are **5–7 minutes** and take place on **Wednesday**: explain the **core concept**, then illustrate it using the listed company — or **another company** of your choice. Contact me **at least one week before** the week of the topic you want. Slots are **first-come, first-served**, and the up-to-date schedule is managed on **Blackboard**.

| # | Week | Date | Topic | Company |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 2 | 09/09 | Initial Public Offerings | SpaceX **WSJ1** |
| 2 | 3 | 09/16 | Current Ratio | **Crocs** vs. **Deckers Outdoor** |
| 3 | 4 | 09/23 | Remaining Performance Obligation | Oracle Corp. **WSJ1** |
| 4 | 5 | 09/30 | Net Profit Margin | **Costco** vs. **Walmart** |
| 5 | 7 | 10/14 | Change in Depreciation Schedule | Big tech firms **WSJ1**, **WSJ2** |
| 6 | 14 | 12/02 | Earnings Per Share and Price-to-Earnings Ratio | **Crocs** vs. **Deckers Outdoor** |

## 8.3 Inclusive Access Program

The Inclusive Access program is used for this course (CONNECT registration link).

- Your CMU account is **charged automatically**, and you have access on the **first day of class**. The CMU Bookstore will email you about the billing process.
- You may **opt out**, but CONNECT is needed for homework and quizzes — if you opt out, you must **purchase access on your own**.

## 8.4 Financial Statement Data Sources

Financial statement data can be obtained from the following websites:

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| SEC EDGAR | Wall Street Journal (WSJ)[3] | Financial Times (FT) | Yahoo Finance |
| CNBC | Finviz | Barchart | Stock Analysis |

## 8.5 Academic Integrity Policy

Work you submit must be the product of your own efforts. Plagiarism, cheating, and other forms of academic dishonesty — including **dishonesty involving the use of AI** — are prohibited.

**Penalty:** Any student found cheating in this course will receive a grade of **F** for the course, and the incident will be reported to the Office of Student Conduct. The full policy is available in the CMU Bulletin.

## 8.6 Disability Accommodation

CMU provides students with disabilities reasonable accommodation to participate in educational programs, activities, or services. If you require accommodation, first register with **Student Disability Services** (120 Park Library; telephone 774-3018; TDD 774-2568), then contact me as soon as possible.

[3] Access the WSJ **for free** through **CMU Libraries**.